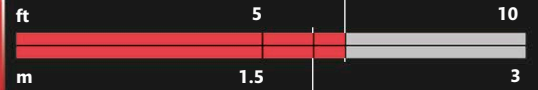


**STRONGEST
BITE:
MARINE
REPTILE**

STATS AND FACTS

The skull fossils of *Pliosaurus* were embedded in a rocky cliff off the coast of Dorset, England. They were exposed over time as the cliff face wore away, but even after they were uncovered, it took paleontologists almost eight years to collect them all.

SKULL LENGTH



The average height of a human male is 6 ft (1.8 m).

Jaws of death

Only *Pliosaurus kevani*'s skull has been found. It contained bone-crushing jaws and teeth capable of clamping down with almost four times the force of a modern-day crocodile's bite. The back of the skull housed the powerful muscles that it used to chomp through its prey.

Dakosaurus, a smaller marine reptile, would have made a tasty meal for *Pliosaurus*.

Sharp, spikelike teeth

AT A GLANCE

- **LENGTH** 41 ft (12.6 m)
- **LIVED** 157–152 MYA
- **DIET** Carnivore
- **HABITAT** Oceans

